SACHITHANANTHAM R., *54*

| CPI(M) | ***Dindigul, Tamil Nadu***

The Dindigul district unit secretary since 2018, the Marxist leader is a three-decade veteran in championing the cause of farmers. He has led agitations across the state, demanding remunerative prices for crops and better wages for farm workers, as well as protests for increased water supply for irrigation. The CPI(M) leader defeated the AIADMK's Mohamed Mubarak M.A. by a margin of over 400,000 votes. He says his major focus will be MSP for all farm produce and reviving the sick spinning mills in Dindigul.



UMESHBHAI PATEL, 48

| INDEPENDENT | ***Daman & Diu (ST)***

An Arts graduate, Umeshbhai first shot into the limelight in 2017 when he led the protest against a Gujarat High Court proposal to merge Daman and Diu with neighbouring Gujarat, for better implementation of the latter's prohibition laws (because of people from the state crossing over to the UT to quench their 'thirst'). Umeshbhai runs various organisations that are engaged in social work in the UT, such as the Daman Youth Action Force and the Swami Vivekanand Vidhyalay. This was his second attempt at entering Parliament and he defeated three-time BJP MP Lalubhai Patel by a margin of 6,225 votes. The Independent candidate reportedly ran a frugal campaign, canvassing with a few friends or his wife and daughter. He has said he will work for the development of Daman and Diu, as the UT has been allegedly ignored by the major parties.



KUNDURU RAGHUVEER, *44*

| CONGRESS | ***Nalgonda, Telangana***

A social activist working for orphaned children, he has set a record for victory margins in Nalgonda, defeating the BJP's Saidi Reddy Shanampudi by 5,59,905 votes.



THARANIVENTHAN M.S., *59*

| DMK | ***Arani, TN***

Has moved up the party rungs since the days he was enlisted as a member way back in 1979. Rallied farmers and farm workers in protests for better prices for produce, apart from demanding improved irrigation facilities. Defeated the AIADMK'S Gajendran G.V.



MATHESWARAN V.S., *52*

| DMK | ***Namakkal, TN***

Matheswaran has in the past highlighted issues faced by those residing in the Senthamangalam panchayat area and served as the Senthamangalam panchayat union vice-chairman. Defeated the AIADMK's Tamilmani S.